NORTHSTAR TECHNOLOGIES

EMPLOYEE HANDBOOK

A practical guide to working at Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

Document ID	HR-POL-001
Document Type	HANDBOOK
Access Scope	ALL_EMPLOYEES
Version	1.0
Effective Date	04 November 2026
Policy Owner	People & Culture Department
Review Cycle	Annual, or when business requirements change

Internal company document • For employees of Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

This handbook is a fictional demonstration document created for the OnBoardIQ demo environment. It is not legal advice and does not replace applicable law, signed employment terms, or formally approved company policies.

Document Control

This handbook introduces the working practices, employee expectations, and shared policies of Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. It is intended for all employees and should be read during onboarding and revisited when policies are updated.

Field	Details
Company	Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd.
Document title	Employee Handbook
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How to use this handbook: Use the section headings to locate a topic. If a situation is not covered, contact your manager or the People & Culture Department rather than making assumptions.

1. Welcome to Northstar

1.1 About the company

Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. is a fictional India-based technology company headquartered in Mumbai. The company builds digital products and business software for customers across multiple industries. Our work brings together engineering, product, design, customer success, operations, and corporate functions.

1.2 Our purpose and values

Our purpose is to make useful technology dependable, accessible, and straightforward to use. We aim to work with integrity, take ownership, learn continuously, collaborate openly, and treat people with respect.

1.3 Who this handbook applies to

This handbook applies to all full-time and part-time employees of Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Contractors, consultants, interns, and vendor personnel must follow the provisions that apply to their engagement and any additional terms in their agreements.

2. Employment and onboarding

2.1 Joining the company

New employees receive an employment letter or agreement that sets out their role, compensation, reporting manager, work location, and other applicable terms. The signed employment terms take precedence if a detail in this handbook conflicts with them.

2.2 Onboarding

During onboarding, employees are expected to complete identity and payroll formalities, review required policies, attend orientation, set up approved accounts, and complete role-specific training. Managers should explain responsibilities, team practices, goals, and the first review milestones.

2.3 Employee information

Employees must provide accurate contact, emergency-contact, bank, tax, and other information required for employment administration. Changes should be submitted promptly through the approved HR process. Access to employee information is limited to authorized personnel.

3. Working hours, attendance, and workplace

3.1 Standard working schedule

The standard schedule for Mumbai-based office teams is Monday to Friday, 9:30 a.m. to 6:30 p.m., including a reasonable meal break. Some roles may follow shift-based, customer-aligned, or project-specific schedules communicated by their manager.

3.2 Attendance and punctuality

Employees should be ready to work at their scheduled start time and record attendance using the company-approved system. If delayed or unable to work, notify the manager as early as possible and follow the team's absence-reporting process.

3.3 Hybrid and remote work

Hybrid or remote work is subject to role requirements and manager approval. Employees working remotely must maintain availability during agreed collaboration hours, protect company information, use approved devices and networks, and attend required meetings.

3.4 Breaks and availability

Employees should take appropriate breaks and coordinate coverage for customer-facing or operational responsibilities. Calendar status and team communication channels should be kept reasonably up to date.

3.5 Workplace facilities

Employees using company premises must follow building access, visitor, safety, cleanliness, and emergency instructions. Company access cards must not be shared.

4. Leave and holidays

4.1 Annual leave

For this demonstration policy, eligible full-time employees receive 18 working days of annual paid leave per calendar year, prorated for eligible partial years of service. Leave should be requested in the HR system and approved by the manager before plans are finalized, except in emergencies.

4.2 Sick and emergency leave

Employees who are unwell or face an urgent personal situation should inform their manager as soon as reasonably possible and record the absence through the approved process. Supporting documents may be requested where permitted by applicable law and company policy.

4.3 Public holidays

The company publishes an annual holiday calendar for applicable work locations. Employees in shift-based roles may receive alternate arrangements communicated by their manager.

4.4 Leave coordination

Managers consider business coverage and employee wellbeing when reviewing requests. Unused leave, carry-forward, encashment, and statutory leave entitlements are governed by the applicable employment terms and local law.

5. Code of conduct and respectful workplace

5.1 Professional behaviour

Employees are expected to act honestly, communicate respectfully, keep commitments, avoid discriminatory or abusive behaviour, and use good judgment when representing Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd.

5.2 Equal opportunity

The company aims to provide a workplace free from discrimination, harassment, bullying, and retaliation. Employment decisions should be based on role-related skills, performance, business needs, and applicable law.

5.3 Harassment and inappropriate conduct

Unwelcome conduct, intimidation, sexual harassment, threats, or repeated hostile behaviour are not acceptable. Employees may raise concerns with People & Culture, their manager, or the designated internal complaints channel. Concerns will be handled as confidentially as reasonably possible and investigated fairly.

5.4 Conflicts of interest

Employees must disclose actual, potential, or perceived conflicts of interest, including outside work, financial interests, close personal relationships in reporting lines, or supplier relationships that could affect impartial judgment.

5.5 Gifts and business courtesies

Employees must not offer or accept gifts, payments, or hospitality that could improperly influence a business decision. When unsure, seek written guidance from the manager or People & Culture before accepting.

6. Information security and acceptable use

6.1 Protect company information

Employees must protect confidential, personal, customer, employee, financial, product, and technical information. Share information only with people who are authorized to receive it and only for legitimate business purposes.

6.2 Accounts and passwords

Use individual company accounts, strong unique passwords, and multi-factor authentication where available. Never share passwords, one-time passcodes, authentication tokens, or session credentials. Report suspected account compromise immediately.

6.3 Devices and software

Use company-managed or explicitly approved devices and software for company work. Keep operating systems and applications updated, enable screen locks, and do not disable endpoint protection or security controls.

6.4 Email, internet, and collaboration tools

Company communication tools are primarily for business use. Be alert to phishing, unexpected attachments, suspicious links, and requests for credentials or payments. Do not send company data to personal email or unapproved file-sharing services.

6.5 Data handling

Store documents in approved company repositories and apply the correct access permissions. Do not copy sensitive data into public AI tools or external services unless the service and use case have been approved. Follow retention and deletion instructions.

6.6 Security incidents

Immediately report lost devices, misdirected emails, suspected phishing, unauthorized access, malware, data exposure, or other security concerns to the IT Helpdesk or Security team. Do not attempt to conceal or independently investigate an incident.

7. Privacy and employee records

7.1 Responsible handling

Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. collects and uses employee information for legitimate purposes such as recruitment, payroll, benefits, access management, safety, compliance, and business operations.

7.2 Access and accuracy

Only authorized personnel may access employee records for approved purposes. Employees should keep their information accurate and raise questions about records with People & Culture.

7.3 Confidentiality

Employees must not access, disclose, export, or use personal information unless their role and a valid business purpose authorize it. Privacy concerns should be reported through the company's designated channel.

8. Company property and intellectual property

8.1 Company assets

Laptops, phones, access cards, documents, software accounts, and other equipment provided by the company remain company property unless stated otherwise in writing. Use them responsibly and report loss, damage, or malfunction promptly.

8.2 Return of assets

When employment ends or an asset is requested back, employees must return company property, remove personal accounts where instructed, and cooperate with the approved access-revocation process.

8.3 Work product

Work created as part of an employee's role or using company resources may be subject to the intellectual-property terms in the employee's agreement and applicable law. Employees must not disclose or reuse proprietary material without authorization.

9. Performance, learning, and development

9.1 Goals and feedback

Employees and managers should agree on clear role goals and review progress regularly. Feedback should be specific, respectful, and focused on outcomes, behaviours, and development.

9.2 Performance reviews

The company aims to conduct structured performance conversations at least twice per year. Reviews may consider delivery, quality, collaboration, customer impact, role expectations, and learning.

9.3 Learning

Employees are encouraged to build role-relevant skills through approved training, knowledge sharing, mentoring, and practical projects. Training that involves external services or company data must follow security and procurement requirements.

10. Communication and issue resolution

10.1 Team communication

Use approved channels for work discussions, document decisions that affect delivery, and keep communication clear and respectful. Employees should raise blockers early and provide accurate status updates.

10.2 Raising a concern

Employees may first speak with their manager where appropriate. They may also contact People & Culture, IT, Security, or another designated function depending on the issue. Urgent safety, harassment, fraud, or security concerns should be reported promptly.

10.3 Non-retaliation

Retaliation against anyone who raises a concern in good faith or participates in an investigation is prohibited. Knowingly false or malicious reports may be addressed through the appropriate process.

11. Health, safety, and emergencies

11.1 Safe workplace

Employees must follow workplace safety instructions, keep work areas safe, and report hazards, injuries, or unsafe conditions. Do not interfere with safety equipment or emergency procedures.

11.2 Emergency response

In an emergency, follow building evacuation instructions, alert the appropriate emergency services where needed, and notify the designated company contact when safe to do so. Keep emergency contact details current.

11.3 Wellbeing

Employees are encouraged to discuss workload, support needs, or workplace concerns with their manager or People & Culture. Requests will be considered in line with available support and applicable policy.

12. Separation and exit process

12.1 Notice and handover

Employees planning to resign should provide written notice in accordance with their employment terms. Managers and employees should agree on a reasonable handover plan for active work, documentation, and customer or team responsibilities.

12.2 Final working day

Before departure, employees must return company assets, complete required handover tasks, submit outstanding expenses, and follow instructions for transferring business records. System access will be managed by authorized teams.

12.3 Final settlement and records

Final payroll, benefits, experience documentation, and other exit matters will be processed according to employment terms and applicable law. Employees may contact People & Culture with questions.

13. Policy administration and acknowledgement

13.1 Policy updates

The People & Culture Department owns this handbook and coordinates reviews with relevant business functions. Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. may update, replace, or withdraw policies as business needs or applicable requirements change. Employees will be informed of material updates through an approved communication channel.

13.2 Questions and interpretation

Questions about this handbook should be directed to the People & Culture Department at people@northstar.example. For IT or security incidents, use the designated IT Helpdesk or Security reporting channel.

13.3 Acknowledgement

Employees are expected to confirm that they have received and read the handbook through the company's onboarding or HR system. Acknowledgement confirms receipt; it does not change the terms of an employee's signed agreement.

Employee acknowledgement

I acknowledge that I have received and read the Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd. Employee Handbook (HR-POL-001, Version 1.0). I understand that I am responsible for following the policies that apply to my role and for seeking clarification when needed.

Employee name: _____

Signature: _____ Date: _____

End of document • HR-POL-001 • Northstar Technologies Pvt. Ltd.